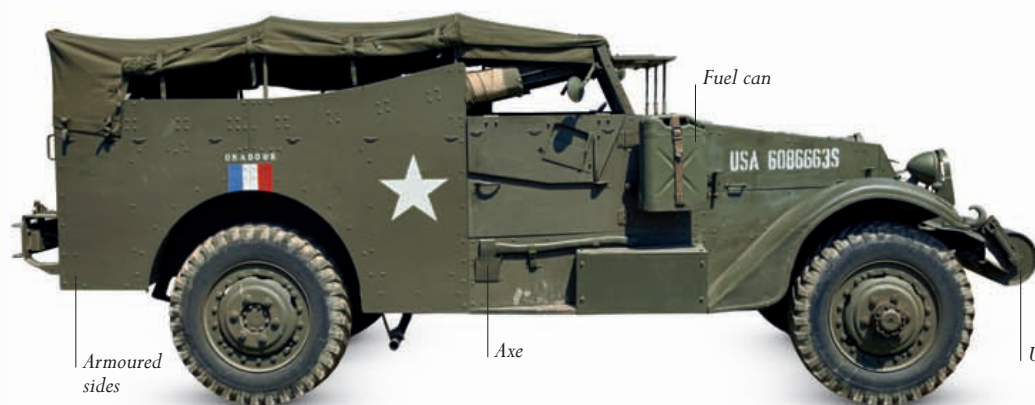


TRUCKS, HALF-TRACKS, AND LIGHT VEHICLES

While tanks and other armoured fighting vehicles have been regarded as the most effective vehicles of World War II, it was the trucks, cars, half-tracks, and other light vehicles that provided the vital logistical backup to the vast armies of the Allies and the Axis powers. For the first time in history, troops in auxiliary services began to outnumber front-line troops. Such support was vital. Not only were there a vast range of vehicles, but a specific model could also come in a bewildering range of variants, each designed to suit a particular role in differing conditions.



▲ M3A1 SCOUT CAR

Date	1940	Origin	US
Weight	4.03 tonnes (4.4 tons)		
Length	5.6m (18½ft)		
Top speed	89kph (55mph)		
Engine	Hercules JXD 6-cylinder 82kW (110hp) petrol engine		

Developed as a light armoured car to support American mechanized formations, the M3A1 suffered from poor off-road mobility, although its best design features were incorporated into the half-tracks that succeeded it.

► R75 MOTORCYCLE COMBINATION

Date	1941	Origin	Germany
Weight	400kg (882lb)		
Length	2.4m (7¾ft)		
Top speed	95kph (59mph)		
Engine	Four-stroke 2-cylinder flat-twin 19kW (25hp) petrol engine		

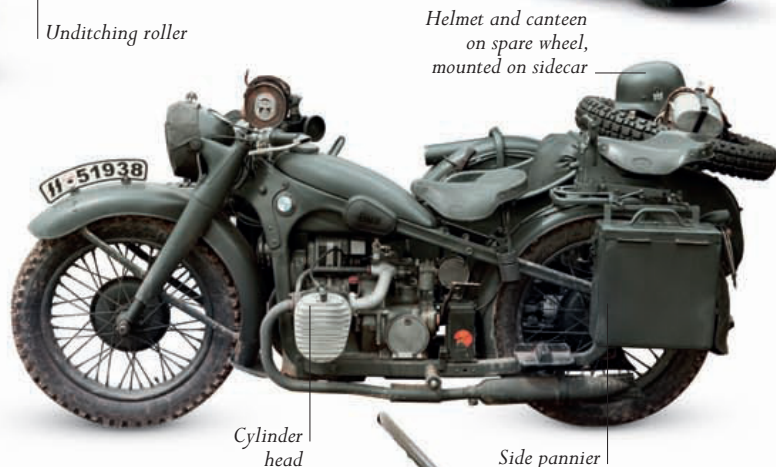
Manufactured by BMW, the R75 was powered by a 750cc engine and utilized a drivetrain that powered the rear wheels of both the bike and the sidecar. Many were armed with a 7.92mm MG34 machine-gun.



▲ SDKFZ 251-8 AUSF C HALF-TRACK

Date	1940	Origin	Germany
Weight	7.8 tonnes (8.6 tons)		
Length	5.8m (19ft)		
Top speed	52.5kph (33mph)		
Engine	Maybach HL 42 6-cylinder 74.6kW (100hp) petrol engine		

Although originally intended as an APC (Armoured Personnel Carrier), the SDKFZ 251 half-track proved so useful that at least 22 separate variants were developed, including this 251-8 battlefield ambulance. Other variants included anti-tank, rocket launcher, and anti-aircraft versions.



► WILLYS JEEP

Date	1941	Origin	US
Weight	1.04 tonnes (1.14 tons)		
Length	3.33m (11ft)		
Top speed	89kph (55mph)		
Engine	Willys 4-cylinder 45kW (60hp) petrol engine		

Technically known as a truck, but more commonly called a jeep, this iconic World War II vehicle was rugged, reliable, and eminently versatile. It had space for four crew.

Windscreen (folded forwards)

